

film reviews

Bundle of Joy

HEY BABY

Director: Sajid Khan
Starring: Akshay Kumar, Fardeen Khan, Ritesh Deshmukh, Vidya Balan

Loosely inspired by *Three Men and a Cradle*, *Heyy Babyy* brims with achingly funny one-liners and asides. The three gleefully promiscuous bachelors who struggle to take care of a baby fathered by one of them ask themselves: dogs are faithful; since we aren't faithful, how can we be dogs?

Unfortunately, Sajid Khan leavens the laughs



Promiscuous bachelors Deshmukh, Kumar and Khan

with long stretches of melodrama, which is pure tedium. After 45 minutes of potty jokes, sexual romps and slapstick, it's difficult to be interested in the emotional lives of these characters.

The second is overtly convoluted and boring. Still, *Heyy Babyy* is a fun ride. Watch out for Deshmukh's Marathi tirades and Fardeen doing a take-off from *Chupke Chupke*. **by Anupama Chopra**

Heartfelt Take

DHOKA

Director: Pooja Bhatt
Starring: Muzammil Ibrahim, Gulshan Grover

Sometimes a movie has to be praised more for its intent than its actuality. "If you kill, it is protection; if we do it, it is terror," says a fundamentalist Muslim to a moderate compatriot who has just found out that his wife was a suicide bomber. The movie takes a



Tulip Joshi and Ibrahim

hard look at the concerns of contemporary Muslims, and for the second time in recent memory (the first was in *Chak De! India*), a Muslim is openly branded a *gaddar* by seemingly sensible Hindus. Unfortunately, the sets are too distractingly goodlooking, as is the male lead, Ibrahim, who bobs his head and screws up his eyes in concentration for the role. But the movie's heart is in the right place.

by Kaveree Bamzai

exhibition Personal Light

DELHI Photographers Gauri Gill and Sunil Gupta bring in their exhibition, 'Gill and Gupta', images replete with a sensibility that is global and contemporary. They look at their subjects with a cultivated reserve and detachment allowing the mood and the subtext to quietly unfold from the picture. Gill documents her neighbourhood in

Gill's brooding image

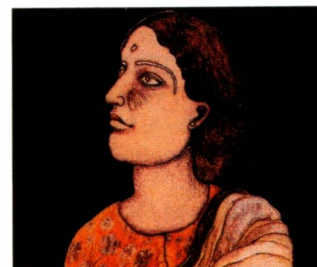
Nizamuddin in brooding, black and white images shot in the dead of the night with a hand-held camera. The pictures reveal her environs as a living presence that she experiences. They eerily mirror the photographer too. Gupta's pictures of Humayun's Tomb are like delicate silkscreen depictions through the membrane of personal experience. The



seemingly impersonal images are constructed with a very fragile balance—blink insensitively and you'll miss it. At ICC Annexe, September 7-16. **by Bandeep Singh**

recommendations

Portrait of a Soul



Chowdhury's work

DELHI Gallery Threshold presents *Body, Mind and Soul*, an exhibition of paintings by Jogen Chowdhury, Prabhakar Kolte and Rameshwar Broota from September 1-6. On display will be reproductions (serigraphs) of their creative expression from the 1980s to the 'threshold' moment of today brought into focus by their recent work. Their individual approaches are inclusive of art history as they transcend current trends to occupy a contemporary place. At Visual Art Gallery.

Dream Theatre



Pathak and Shah

HYDERABAD The Qadir Ali Baig Theatre Foundation has lined up a four-play festival with *Ismat Aapa Ke Naam* directed by Naseeruddin Shah featuring him, Ratna Pathak and Heeba Shah. The couple will be on stage again in Pandit Satyadev Dubey's *Dear Liar*. *Bikhre Bimb* directed by Girish Karnad and M. Chaitanya features Arundhati Nag and the last one is *Taramati: The Legend of an Artist* directed by Mohammed Ali Baig. September 6-9 at Ravindra Bharati. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**